

Inferencing

GRADE
3

Using **clues** from the text and what you **already know** to figure things out!

An **inference** is a smart guess you make when the author doesn't tell you something directly.

How to Make an Inference

1. Read the Text

Pay close attention to the details.



2. Use What You Know

Think about your own experiences and what you already know.



3. Put It Together

Combine the clues from the text and what you know to make a smart inference.



Example

Clues in the Text

Maya pulled her jacket tighter, shivered, and looked up at the dark clouds.



What I Know

When I see dark clouds and someone is cold, it might start to rain.



My Inference

I infer that it is going to rain soon.



Why It Matters

Inferencing helps you understand the story better and become a stronger reader!

Think to Yourself

- ✓ What clues does the author give me?
- ✓ What do I already know?
- ✓ What is the smart guess I can make?



Inference Examples

Good readers use **clues** to make **smart guesses**!



1. It Must Have Rained



Clues in the Text:

- The ground is wet.
- There are puddles on the path.
- The flowers have water on them.

Inference:

It must have rained recently.



2. She Was Excited



Clues in the Text:

- Her eyes were wide.
- She was smiling from ear to ear.
- She jumped up and down.

Inference:

She was excited about the surprise.



3. He Was Tired



Clues in the Text:

- He yawned several times.
- He rubbed his eyes.
- He moved slowly.

Inference:

He was tired.



4. They Care About Their Pet



Clues in the Text:

- They give the dog fresh water.
- They brush its fur.
- They take it for walks every day.

Inference:

They care about their pet.



5. The Movie Was Scary



Clues in the Text:

- They jumped when a loud noise came.
- They held the blanket tightly.
- Their eyes were wide.

Inference:

The movie was scary.



6. He Worked Hard



Clues in the Text:

- He studied for a long time.
- He took notes.
- He didn't stop even when it was hard.

Inference:

He worked hard to do his best.



Remember:

An inference is not something the author tells you. It is something **YOU** figure out using clues!

Think to Yourself

- ✓ What clues can I see?
- ✓ What do I already know?
- ✓ What smart guess can I make?





Inference Examples



Readers use **clues** from the text and their own knowledge to make **smart guesses**!

1. The Empty Lunchbox



Clues in the Text:

- His lunchbox is empty.
- He looks down sadly.
- He didn't eat anything.

Inference:

He might have forgotten his lunch.



2. The Windy Day



Clues in the Text:

- Her hair is blowing.
- The leaves are flying.
- She is holding onto her hat.

Inference:

It must be very windy.



3. The Birthday Party



Clues in the Text:

- There is a cake with candles.
- There are balloons and presents.
- She looks surprised and happy.

Inference:

It must be her birthday.



4. The Muddy Shoes



Clues in the Text:

- His shoes are covered in mud.
- There is a soccer ball on the ground.
- He is sitting on the front step.

Inference:

He has been playing outside, probably soccer.



5. The Winter Morning



Clues in the Text:

- She is wearing a hat, scarf and mittens.
- You can see her breath.
- There is frost on the ground.

Inference:

It must be very cold.



6. The Heavy Backpack



Clues in the Text:

- He is leaning forward.
- His backpack looks very full.
- He has a strained expression.

Inference:

His backpack is very heavy.



Remember:

The author doesn't always tell you everything. Use the **clues** and your own knowledge to make an **inference**!

Think to Yourself



- ✓ What clues can I find in the text?
- ✓ What do I already know that can help me?
- ✓ What smart guess (inference) can I make?

Inference Examples

Use **clues** from the text and what you already know to make a **smart guess**!



1. Late for School



Clues in the Text:

- He is rushing.
- His backpack is half open.
- He didn't eat breakfast.
- He keeps looking at the clock.

Inference:

He is probably late for school.



2. The Burning Smell



Clues in the Text:

- She is holding her nose.
- Smoke is coming from the toaster.
- She toast is black.
- She looks worried.

Inference:

She probably burned the toast.



3. A Special Surprise



Clues in the Text:

- There are balloons and decorations.
- There are wrapped presents.
- His parents told him to stay out of the room.
- He has a big smile.

Inference:

There is probably a birthday surprise for him.



4. The Thirsty Dog



Clues in the Text:

- The dog is panting.
- It is a hot, sunny day.
- The water bowl is almost empty.
- The dog is drinking quickly.

Inference:

The dog is very thirsty and hot.



5. The Absent Friend



Clues in the Text:

- Her friend's desk is empty.
- There is a "Get well soon" card on the board.
- The teacher said her friend won't be here today.
- She looks a little sad.

Inference:

Her friend is probably sick.



6. The Camping Trip



Clues in the Text:

- She is packing a tent and sleeping bag.
- There is a lantern and a camp stove.
- She is wearing warm clothes.
- Her parents are loading the car.

Inference:

They are probably going camping.



Remember:

An inference is a smart guess.
You use **clues** + what you **already know** to figure things out!



Think to Yourself

- ✓ What clues does the author give me?
- ✓ What do I already know?
- ✓ What smart guess (inference) can I make?



Name: _____

Date: _____



Making Inferences

An inference
is a smart
guess based
on clues!



Read each short passage or look at the picture.
Use **clues** and what you already know to make an **inference**.



For each one, write your **inference** on the line and tell which **clues** helped you.

1 Soccer Practice



Ben came home
sweaty and tired.
His socks were muddy,
and his shirt was wet.
He quickly took a
shower and ate a big
bowl of pasta.

My inference: _____

Clues I used: _____

2 The Dark Window



Isla looked out the
window. The sky was
dark, and lightning
flashed in the
distance. She heard
thunder rumbling.
She quickly closed
the window.

My inference: _____

Clues I used: _____

3 The Birthday Card



Liam opened the card
and grinned from ear
to ear. He hugged his
sister and said,
"This is the best
present ever!"

My inference: _____

Clues I used: _____

4 The Abandoned Lunch



Maya's lunch was
sitting on the kitchen
counter. No one had
eaten it. Her bag
was still packed by
the door.

My inference: _____

Clues I used: _____

5 The Sleepy Cat



The cat is curled up
in a warm blanket.
Its eyes are closed,
and it is purring
softly.

My inference: _____

Clues I used: _____

6 The Lost Toy



Emma is looking
under the couch
and behind the
curtains. Her face
looks upset.
She is holding her
favourite teddy.

My inference: _____

Clues I used: _____



Think About It!

Which inference was the easiest to make?

Which was the hardest? Why?



Remember!

Good readers use **clues** + what
they already know to make
smart guesses!





Making Inferences

Use **clues** from the text and what you **already know** to make a smart guess!



Read each passage and look at the picture.
Write an **inference** and the **clues** that helped you.



An **inference** is something the author does not say.
It is a smart guess you make using **clues** and what you already know!

1 The Rainy Game



Jack was dressed in his soccer uniform. He had his ball and water bottle ready. He walked to the window and sighed when he saw the heavy rain.

My inference: _____

Clues I used: _____

2 The Trash Can



Sophie carefully tied the bag and carried it to the end of the driveway. She opened the lid, dropped the bag in, and washed her hands.

My inference: _____

Clues I used: _____

3 The Early Morning



Ethan's alarm went off at 6:15 a.m. He rolled out of bed, stretched big, and immediately walked to the kitchen in his pajamas.

My inference: _____

Clues I used: _____

4 The Library Book



Mia checked out a thick book about sharks. She carried it carefully and didn't stop reading until the librarian called it closing time.

My inference: _____

Clues I used: _____

5 The Muddy Puppy



The puppy ran inside with muddy paws. He shook himself off on the rug and knocked over a plant with his wagging tail.

My inference: _____

Clues I used: _____

6 The Class Presentation



Ben took a deep breath, held his note cards, and looked at his classmates. He started speaking clearly and didn't stop smiling.

My inference: _____

Clues I used: _____



Think About It!

- Which story was the easiest to make an inference about? Why?

- Which story was the hardest? Why?



Remember!

Good readers use **clues** + what they already know = **smart guesses!**
The more **clues** you find, the better your inference will be!

